

Yuxuan Pang

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EDUCATION

- University of Chicago**, Chicago, IL. **September 2024 – June 2026**
Program: Master of Digital Study, AI and language concentration **GPA:** 4.0/4.0
Master's Honors Thesis: Existential Cognition: A Computational Analysis of Existential Discourse
Coursework: Data Management, Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, NLP and Deep Learning, Game Design
- Washington University in St. Louis**, St. Louis, MO. **August 2019 – December 2023**
Program: B.A. in Economics, minor in Computer Science & Philosophy **GPA:** 3.92/4.0
Academic Accolades: Dean's List Recipient
Coursework: Computer Science, Statistics, Econometrics, Biology, Organic Chemistry, Research Methods, Calculus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Human Nature and Development Lab, University of Chicago** **February 2025 – Present**
Research Assistant – Computational Social Science
- Conduct research focused on existential psychology, emotional cognition, and online mental health discourse.
 - Analyze large-scale text datasets from Reddit, Google Books to identify psychological and emotional patterns.
 - Apply NLP and statistical methods to examine themes related to anxiety, meaning, mortality, and emotional coping.
 - Support survey research investigating psychological responses to existential thought and uncertainty.
- University of Chicago** **Jan 2026 – March 2026**
Teaching Assistant – Statistics Computing with Python
- Assisted in teaching a graduate course on statistical analysis using Python.
 - Guided students in applying Python libraries (NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib) for data analysis.
 - Provided feedback on assignments involving statistical modeling and coding.
- Bank of China**, Beijing, China **December 2023 – February 2024**
Front-End Developer Intern
- Helped develop a JavaScript interface for an internal system managing account and transaction data.
 - Built a transaction lookup interface to visualize international transaction flows.
 - Collaborated with backend engineers to debug API data rendering and improve interface functionality.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

- Existential Cognition: A Computational Analysis of Existential Discourse in Online Communities**
Master's Honors Thesis, University of Chicago
- Conducted large-scale computational analysis of over 330,000 Reddit comments related to existential thought, depression, anxiety, and emotional coping.
 - Used machine learning and NLP methods including topic modeling, semantic clustering, and transformer-based language models to identify psychological themes in online discourse.
 - Identified recurring domains including meaning and purpose, mortality awareness, uncertainty, and self-reflection.
 - Combined computational methods with psychological theory to study how individuals express existential concerns in naturalistic settings.

Red Panda's Journey — Narrative Adventure Game

- Team Lead & Art Director - Led a 4-person interdisciplinary team in the design and development of a narrative adventure game.
- Defined the product vision, user experience goals, and creative direction across gameplay, environment design, and progression systems.
 - Coordinated designers, artists, and developers to align technical implementation with user experience objectives.
 - Iterated on game features through testing and feedback to improve engagement and player experience.

SKILLS

- Programming:** Python, C#, Java, Javascript, HTML, Machine Learning, NLP, Deep Learning, Topic Modeling, Data Analysis
Research & Psychology: Psychological Research, Quantitative Research Methods, Survey Research, Data Analysis Emotional & Behavioral, Text Analysis, Literature Review
Tools & Software: Excel, Jupyter Notebook, Matplotlib, STATA, Unity, Blender, Photoshop
Data & Digital Research: Text Analysis, Data Visualization, Network Analysis, Database Architecture (MySQL), Corpus Analysis

Creative & Design: 3D Modeling, Digital Art, Animation, Character Design, Illustration, Painting
Languages: English, Mandarin Chinese